

Chapter 91-1

The next day was sunny. Sunlight passed through the thick gray fabric curtains, refracting into the room through the gaps.

Liang Shi's head felt heavy and dull. She instinctively raised her arm to cover her eyes. The weight of her arm gave her eyes a moment of relief, her eyelashes pressed flat. Then, finding it uncomfortable, she turned over and buried her head in the pillow, smelling a strong scent of old wood.

She woke up immediately.

Liang Shi sat on the bed in a daze. The room was empty, the back of her head ached a bit, and her mind was blank.

She reached back to touch the back of her head. There was a small bump.

Hiss...

The pain made her draw in a sharp breath.

Liang Shi couldn't help but complain again—this body's constitution was really no good, unable to handle even that little bit of alcohol.

But she forgot that last night she had been mixing baijiu and Western liquor¹. Seeing how many people in the production were drinking that way, she had tried it too. Plus, she had drunk some before eating, and drank too quickly, so the aftereffects hit hard.

The hangover aftermath showed itself again—when she first woke up, she couldn't remember anything.

But when she reached over to the other side of the bed, it was still warm.

Had she slept with someone?

Or had she just been tossing and turning during the night?

But Liang Shi's behavior when drunk was pretty decent. She shouldn't have done something like fooling around just because she drank too much.

She first got up to open the curtains. The dazzling sunlight made her instinctively squint.

The memories began to slowly return.

Last night, after hanging up the video call with Xu Qingzhu, she had added Gu Yixue on WeChat based on the email, then sent her a "hello" sticker on WeChat.

Gu Yixue had replied with a voice message, her tone lazy and languid, as if she was still smoking, her voice a bit dry: "I drank a bit too much today. Sorry, let's talk about the role tomorrow."

Her Beijing accent² became heavier when she was drunk. Liang Shi had listened to it twice before putting down her phone.

Talk tomorrow?

That meant there really was a role!

She had been happy at the time and a bit thirsty, so she picked up the beer on the hotel table and drank a bottle.

Combined with the alcohol from before kicking in, she became dizzy. She lay on the bed planning to sleep and was almost asleep when she was startled awake by a knock at the door. But she thought she was dreaming.

...

Liang Shi really hated her hangover aftermath.

She wished she could be a second Xu Qingzhu—going crazy after drinking too much, but not remembering any of it afterward.

As long as she wasn't embarrassed, others would be the embarrassed ones.

But Liang Shi would recover all her memories the day after sobering up, with vivid tactile sensations.

The area on her neck seemed to be burning. She went to the bathroom to look, and in the mirror, she saw a strawberry mark³ on the side of her neck.

Sucked out.

Liang Shi: "..."

Not only that, there was also one below her collarbone. Actually, Xu Qingzhu had also bitten her once, but after a night, the teeth marks were gone. The traces from the sucking remained, and after a night of developing, they had become even more vivid.

She immediately checked—there were only marks in these two places on her body.

The most obvious one was on the side of her neck. No matter how Liang Shi tried to cover it, she couldn't hide it, since it was close to her jawline and toward the front.

Liang Shi had accidentally bumped her head on the headboard when she was pulling Xu Qingzhu to lie down on the bed.

It had hurt so much she went numb, and her eyes immediately welled up with tears.

Xu Qingzhu had reached out to rub it for her, and then... she seemed to have buried her head in Xu Qingzhu's chest, taken a particularly indulgent sniff, lightly licked her skin with the tip of her tongue, and said in a low voice: "Teacher Xu, so soft."

Xu Qingzhu had slapped her right on the spot she had just bumped.

The hit made her feel wronged, so Xu Qingzhu rubbed her head again, and then... she fell asleep.

After that... there was no after that.

When Liang Shi woke up and checked the time, it was obvious that Xu Qingzhu had already gotten up and gone to work.

After opening the curtains, she pressed her forehead against the glass and lightly bumped it several times.

Regret, so much regret.

Why did she have to drink?

Drinking too much always led to embarrassment.

Footnotes:

¹ **Baijiu and Western liquor (白酒洋酒):** Baijiu is a strong Chinese distilled spirit typically made from sorghum, with alcohol content usually between 40-60%. Mixing it with Western liquors (like whiskey, vodka, etc.) is generally considered a recipe for getting very drunk very quickly.

² **Beijing accent (京味兒):** A distinctive accent and manner of speaking associated with native Beijing residents, characterized by certain pronunciations and colloquialisms. It often becomes more pronounced when someone is relaxed or intoxicated.

³ **Strawberry mark (草莓印):** Chinese slang for a hickey/love bite, named for its resemblance to a strawberry due to its red color and shape.